



MONTHLY UPDATE

Research institutions: monthly update, August 2026

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12 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · COMOROS · CONGO · COTE D'IVOIRE · ETHIOPIA · KENYA · LIBYA · MOZAMBIQUE
· NIGER · RWANDA · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Central African Republic

Nothing moved in the research base this period. What changed is the record: the base had carried no university, statistics-institute or donor research document for the country at all, and now holds the University of Bangui's [Institut supérieur de technologie](#), which supplies most of the country's professional engineering graduates and runs a master's in engineering sciences. The page carries no date, enrolment or research-output figure, so the position it settles is one of existence rather than of scale.

Comoros

The research institute that has run the data-governance work since May [recorded the national data strategy as validated on 26 August, delivered through a joint African Union, European Union and German cooperation project after technical capacity-building on localising the continental data policy framework](#). It is the third such strategy the project has delivered, after the Gambia and Somalia. The research contribution on file is a foreign institute's; no Comorian department is named as authoring any of it.

Congo

Researchers and faculty met in Brazzaville on 21 and 22 August to [set rules for the use of artificial intelligence in research](#). No code, guideline text or adopting institution has come out of it yet.

Cote d'Ivoire

The cyber agency and a technology school validated curricula for two cyber-security master's degrees on 28 July, with enrolment stated for the September 2026 academic year and no intake size or funding published.

Ethiopia

University connectivity is the delivery side of the research position. A funder's account [describes campus connectivity transforming learning across Ethiopian campuses](#). It is the funder's own account, with no bandwidth, campus count or student figure in the record held.

Against it the FY2026/27 federal budget [carries Artificial Intelligence University Construction as a single named capital project at ETB 5,000,000,000](#) – domestic money, appropriated rather than pledged, and large enough to dominate the year's digital total on its own. Nothing moved on the national artificial-intelligence policy itself, on model development, or on which foundation models the country runs.

Kenya

The base gained its first account of a named Kenyan data-science career, a [data-for-social-impact leader profiled](#) in a series of conversations with practitioners. It is an interview rather than an institutional record, and carries no programme, funding or output figure.

Libya

On 4 August the Libyan Authority for Scientific Research's scientific committee [approved an integrated cloud platform for higher education and scientific research](#), described in the authority's own account as using Microsoft 365.

Mozambique

At the university data centre's inauguration the communications minister proposed transferring management of the research and education network from his own ministry to the universities, naming no date, instrument or governance model ([ministerial account](#)).

Niger

The [Council of Ministers of 21 August 2026 took decisions on research and innovation](#). Cabinet conclusions name what is decided without carrying the text of it, so the base holds the announcement and not the instruments.

Rwanda

An [academic security operation centre is running through a university network based in Rwanda, described as operating on multiple levels to meet cybersecurity monitoring needs and to build a cybersecurity workforce in Rwanda and beyond](#). No monitored-estate, incident or staffing figure is published, so the size of what the centre actually does cannot be stated from the base.

South Africa

The month's one research measure is about the literature rather than the country. A twenty-year bibliometric review [places South Africa 18th worldwide and the only African country among the twenty most productive sources of digital-privacy research, across 4,760 articles published between 2005 and 2025](#). The same review finds refugees, people with disabilities, older people and racial and ethnic minorities notably underrepresented in that literature, so the ranking counts output and not coverage of the populations whose privacy is least protected.

Tanzania

A national institution of science and technology was [selected as the country's only member of the global AI capacity development network, announced at its graduation ceremony on 22 August 2026](#). The network is supported by the UN office for digital and emerging technologies, was itself launched in July 2026, and works across AI foundations, AI enablers, capacity development and open science.

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